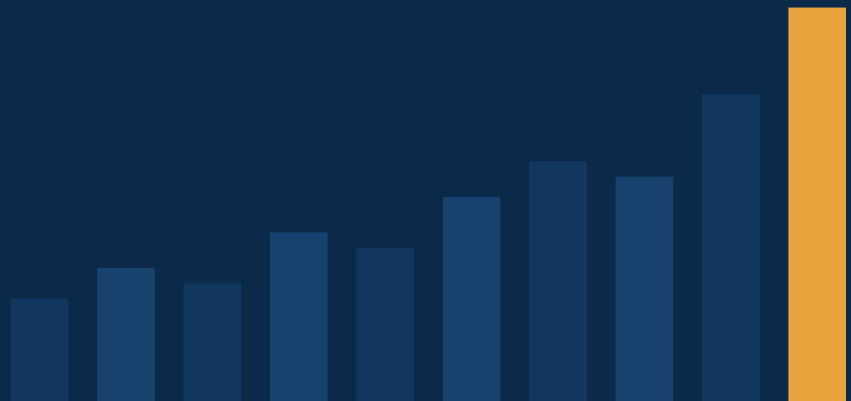


WORKBOOK

PARTICIPANT

Participant Workbook

Power BI Storytelling and Report Design for Business Impact



Version 1.0, October 2026

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Welcome

How to use this workbook

This workbook is yours to write in. It holds a page for every discussion, exercise, and lab worksheet of the day, in the order you will meet them. Each page shows the slide it belongs to and the time you have.

- **Write in it.** A sketch or a half sentence is enough. Nobody collects it.
- **There are no answers in it.** Your instructor debriefs each activity. Space is left for what you hear.
- **The lab steps are in the Participant Lab Guide.** This workbook holds the worksheets that go with them.

The scenario company, Ridgemere Wealth Management, is fictional. Every person, market, and number in it was invented for this course. Nothing in this workbook is BMO data.

Your day

Time	Block	In this workbook
9:00 to 9:30	Opening: from data display to business story	Activity 1
9:30 to 10:30	Module 1: think like the business user	Activities 2, 3, 4, and 5
10:45 to 12:00	Module 2: story architecture and choosing the right visual	Activities 6 and 7, Lab 1 sketch page
1:00 to 2:00	Module 3: designing the Power BI user experience	Activity 8, Lab 2 page
2:00 to 3:15	Module 4: guided Power BI build and refinement	Lab 3 part B page, Lab 3 part F page
3:30 to 4:30	Module 5: report critique and BMO scenario workshop	Activity 9, the report clinic packet
4:30 to 5:00	Wrap-up: publish, review, and sustain	Activity 10, review checklist, action plan

Breaks are at 10:30 and 3:15. Lunch is 12:00 to 1:00.

Before we start

Slide 4 lists eight outcomes for the day. Tick the **one** that matters most to you.

- ☐ Translate a request into audience, decision, questions, evidence, and action
- ☐ Structure pages so the key insight is found fast
- ☐ Choose visuals by analytical intent, including tables and matrices
- ☐ Cut visual noise and slicer overload
- ☐ Design summary-to-detail journeys with interactions and drillthrough
- ☐ Apply themes and consistent formatting deliberately
- ☐ Explain how the semantic model supports trustworthy reporting
- ☐ Critique reports with a repeatable checklist

Four terms we use precisely (slide 7)

Term	Meaning
Report	A multiperspective view into a single semantic model. One or many pages of visuals.
Dashboard	A single place in the Power BI service to monitor current state, built from pinned tiles of underlying reports.
Semantic model	The reusable layer that a report is built on.
Workspace	Where reports are published in the Power BI service.

The core design question

Slide 8 asks one question. It frames everything else today.

Ask

What should the business user notice, understand, explore, and do?

Answer it for one report that you own. You will come back to this report at the end of the day.

My report	
Notice	
Understand	
Explore	
Do	

Meet Ridgemere

The scenario

Ridgemere Wealth Management is the wealth business of the fictional Ridgemere Financial Group. It serves more than 10,000 client households through 244 advisors in 51 branches. The branches form 18 markets, and the markets form 5 regions.

Ridgemere's fiscal year runs from 1 November to 31 October. Fiscal 2026 (FY2026) closed a few days ago, and the year-end review is next week. You are an analyst on Ridgemere's Wealth Data and Analytics team.

The people you design for

Person	Role	How they use a report
Catherine Bouchard	Head of Wealth Distribution	Wants the number, fast, and the one thing to worry about. Reads on a tablet before the executive committee.
Daniel Okafor	Regional Vice President, Mountain	Has to explain his region's result and decide where to spend his time.
Priya Raman	Market Leader, Foothills	Acts on household-level detail. Wants a call list.
Tom Nguyen	Director, Wealth Planning	Wants to know where plan adoption is weak and how large the opportunity is.
Sofia Mendes	Head of Partner Referrals	Owns referrals from other lines of business. Wants to know whether referral growth is turning into business.

Regions and markets

Region	Markets
Atlantic	Capital District, Eastgate, Kingsport, Seacliff
Central	Heartland, Prairie Crossing, Riverbend, Twin Forks
Great Lakes	Bayfront, Lakeshore, Millbrook, Stonegate
Mountain	Foothills, High Plains, Summit Ridge
Pacific	Bayview, Coastline, Evergreen

The words Ridgemere uses

Term	Meaning at Ridgemere
Revenue	Revenue earned from clients in the period. Each advisor has a revenue target, set at the start of the fiscal year.
Client balances	What clients hold with Ridgemere at the end of a period. A snapshot, not a total.
Net flows	Net new client money: inflows less outflows, excluding market movement.
New accounts	Accounts opened in the period. "New openings" in everyday speech.
Household	One client family or entity, served by one advisor.
Wealth plan, plan adoption	A documented financial plan for a household. Plan adoption is the share of active households with an active plan.
Referral, opportunity	An opportunity is a possible piece of new business. A referral is an opportunity sent to an advisor by another line of business.
Stalled	An open opportunity with no activity for 45 days or more.
Retention risk	A rule-based flag on each household: High, Medium, or Low.

My notes on the scenario

Activity 1: The five-second test

Timing: 10 minutes, Opening, slide 9

Five seconds to look. Two minutes in pairs. Then we collect what the room noticed.

Your instructor will show you a report page for five seconds. You have one job: decide whether Ridgemere had a good year.

After five seconds

Good year or bad year? What was the headline?

With your neighbor (2 minutes)

The page is back on the screen. Look at it properly this time.

What did your eye land on first?

What question does this page answer?

What would Catherine Bouchard have to do to get an answer from it?

What the room noticed

Write the patterns as the group names them. Slide 9 will name four.

	Pattern	Where I saw it on the page
1		
2		
3		
4		

Two things to keep in mind

Your instructor will leave you with two questions about this page. Write them here. You will answer both this afternoon.

The shift we are making today (slide 10)

Before: data display	After: business story
Starts from the list of requested metrics	Starts from the decision, questions, and actions of the user
Every visual gets equal space	The key insight is visually dominant
The user works out the meaning	A clear path leads to detail when needed

Which column describes the last report I built? What makes me say so?

Activity 2: Hidden questions

Timing: 3 minutes, Module 1, slide 13

On your own, then two people share.

A request usually arrives as a list of things to show: "show me X by Y". Behind it there is a question that somebody needs answered.

Slide 13 gives an example. Requested: revenue, trends, new openings. Behind it: are we on target, which segments need attention, and where should advisors act?

Think of a request that **you** received recently.

The request, as it arrived:

The real question behind it:

How I found out, or how I could have:

Notes from the discussion

Tip: Try this at work

Next time a request arrives as a list of metrics, reply with one question: "What will you decide or do once you have this?" The answer is usually the real requirement.

Activity 3: True but misleading

Timing: 5 minutes, Module 1, slide 16
Three minutes in pairs. Then two pairs share.

Slide 16 asks three questions. The third is the one this activity is about: **what context prevents a wrong conclusion?**

Each statement below was read from a Ridgemere report page. None of them is a typing error. Each one could send a reader to the wrong conclusion.

With your partner, choose **two** statements. For each one, write what you would ask before you repeated it to an executive.

	Statement	What would I ask first? What context is missing?
1	"Revenue is \$554 million."	
2	"Client balances total \$738 billion."	
3	"We finished the year 1.2% ahead of our revenue target."	
4	"Louis Patel beat his revenue target by 77%."	
5	"Wealth plans cover 49% of households."	

After the debrief

Which of these would your own reports have caught? Which would have slipped through?

Activity 4: Tier the metrics

Timing: 4 minutes, Module 1, slide 17

Two minutes on your own, two minutes to compare with the room.

Slide 17 sorts metrics into three tiers. **Primary signals** are the headline numbers. **Diagnostic context** explains why a number moved. **Supporting detail** is the records and lookups.

Catherine Bouchard is preparing for the FY2026 year-end review. Mark each metric **P** (primary), **D** (diagnostic), or **S** (supporting) for her.

	Metric	P, D, or S	My reason, in a few words
1	Advisor-level revenue against target		
2	Revenue against target for FY2026		
3	Net flows by month		
4	Household list with days since last contact		
5	Client balances at year end		
6	Revenue variance by market		
7	New accounts opened		
8	Households lost during the year		
9	List of open opportunities		
10	Net flows against target		
11	Revenue variance by product line		
12	Monthly revenue against target		

Where each tier lives (slide 18)

Tier	Where it belongs in the report
Primary signals	
Diagnostic context	
Supporting detail	

One more question. Would your answers change if the reader were Priya Raman, the Foothills market leader, instead of Catherine?

Activity 5: Requirement-to-story map

Timing: 15 minutes in pairs, then a 5 minute debrief. Module 1, slide 20

Power BI stays closed. Choose one request card, or a real request of your own with any confidential detail removed.

A requirement-to-story map turns a request into design decisions before a single visual exists. Choose one of the four requests below and complete the map on the next page.

Card A: production

From: Catherine Bouchard, Head of Wealth Distribution

Year-end review is Thursday. Can you send me revenue, balances, accounts, and new openings for FY2026 by region? One page please. I will read it on my tablet on the way in.

Card B: wealth planning

From: Tom Nguyen, Director, Wealth Planning

I need a dashboard of plan adoption. Every market, every asset band, with all the client attributes so the teams can filter however they like.

Card C: referrals

From: Sofia Mendes, Head of Partner Referrals

Referrals are up a lot since the commercial banking program launched. Please build me a report that shows referral counts by line of business, month, and advisor so I can show the partners how well it is going.

Card D: trend review

From: Daniel Okafor, Regional Vice President, Mountain

Balances in my region are down and I keep being asked why. Send me the monthly trend for Mountain so I can take it to my market leaders.

Tip: Three things that make a map useful

- Name a person or a role as the audience. "Management" is not an audience.
- Write the insight as one sentence with blanks for the numbers. A list of metrics is not an insight.
- Write an action that somebody takes after reading. "Review the report" is not an action.

Our map

Request card: A, B, C, D, or our own (circle one)

Element	Our answer
Audience Who opens it? Quick-answer or exploratory?	
Decision What will they decide or do?	
Questions The real questions behind the request. Three at most.	
Insight The headline we hope to state. One sentence, with blanks for the numbers.	
Evidence and context What makes them trust it? What prevents a wrong conclusion?	
Action What happens next, and who does it?	
Reading path Visible immediately. Invites exploration. Belongs on a detail page.	

What we decided to leave off the first page:

A second map, for a request of your own

Use this copy for a real request when you are back at your desk, or now if you chose your own.

The request, in the requester's words:

Element	My answer
Audience Who opens it? Quick-answer or exploratory?	
Decision What will they decide or do?	
Questions The real questions behind the request. Three at most.	
Insight The headline I hope to state. One sentence, with blanks for the numbers.	
Evidence and context What makes them trust it? What prevents a wrong conclusion?	
Action What happens next, and who does it?	
Reading path Visible immediately. Invites exploration. Belongs on a detail page.	

Activity 6: Match the visual

Timing: 5 minutes, Module 2, slide 23

Your instructor reads each question. Call out the visual you would start with.

The question picks the visual. For each Ridgemere question, name the **type of question** (trend, ranking, variance, part-to-whole, distribution, correlation, or exact lookup) and the **visual you would start with**.

	Business question	Type of question	Visual I would start with
1	How has revenue moved against target over the 12 months?		
2	Which five markets have the highest net flows?		
3	How did each product line add to or subtract from the revenue variance?		
4	What share of client balances is in each product line?		
5	How are households spread across asset bands?		
6	Do advisors with higher plan adoption have higher organic growth?		
7	What exactly was Paul Peters's revenue against target?		
8	How does the monthly net flow pattern differ across the five regions?		

One sentence to keep

Write the teaching point from the debrief in your own words.

On my own reports. A visual of mine that is the default choice, not the right choice:

Activity 7: The slicer decision test

Timing: 3 minutes, Module 2, slide 29
Thirty seconds to mark your answers, then a show of hands.

Slide 29 gives the test: **each slicer must change a decision, or it moves to the Filters pane.**

The page **Performance (Before)** has ten slicers. Catherine Bouchard is the reader. Mark each slicer:

- **K** Keep it on the page. It changes a decision for this reader.
- **F** Move it to the Filters pane. Useful sometimes, but it should not take space on the page.
- **R** Remove it from this page. It belongs on a detail page, or the reader reaches it another way.

	Slicer	K, F, or R	If K: the decision it changes
1	Region		
2	Market		
3	Branch		
4	Team		
5	Role		
6	Product Group		
7	Product Line		
8	Fiscal Quarter		
9	Month		
10	Fiscal Year		

How many did you keep? _____

On my own reports

A slicer on one of my pages that never changes a decision, and what my readers would lose if it moved to the Filters pane:

Lab 1 sketch page

Timing: Lab 1, 25 minutes, Module 2, slide 32

The steps are in the Participant Lab Guide. This page holds your notes for part A and your sketch for part B.

Part A: what I changed on Visual Challenge

	The question	The visual I chose
1	How has revenue tracked against target through the year?	
2	Which markets are furthest behind their revenue target?	
3	How did each product line contribute to the revenue variance?	
4	Do advisors with higher plan adoption attract more net new money?	
5	Where is plan adoption weakest, by market and asset band?	
6	What share of client balances sits in each product line?	

Visual 6: my decision, and my reason.

What would have to be different about the data for my answer to change?

Part C: start the build (5 minutes)

The steps are in the lab guide. Tick each one when it is done.

- ☐ A new page named Executive Summary, in first position
- ☐ A page filter: Fiscal Year is FY2026
- ☐ One card with four values: Revenue, Client Balances, Net Flows, New Accounts
- ☐ The file saved under my own name

Part B: the page Catherine should have received (8 minutes, in pairs)

Keep to the limits in the lab guide: one headline sentence, no more than four numbers, no more than three charts, no more than one slicer, and a note that says where the detail lives.

Our headline sentence (leave blanks for the numbers):

Our executive summary for Catherine (16:9 report canvas). Boxes and labels, not artwork.

The question each chart answers:

Where the detail lives, and how a reader gets there:

Activity 8: Clarify or distract

Timing: 2 minutes, Module 3, slide 37
Mark each one, then compare with your neighbor.

Every selection on a page affects the other visuals, unless you decide otherwise. Slide 37 gives the test: keep the interactions that answer "which segment drives this?", and turn off the ones that blank out the headline or reshape unrelated visuals.

For each interaction, mark **Keep** or **Turn off**.

	The interaction	Keep or turn off	Why
1	On an executive page, selecting a market filters the monthly trend chart.		
2	On an executive page, selecting a market changes the firm's headline card.		
3	On a detail page, selecting a month in the trend chart filters the table of advisors.		
4	Selecting a slice of a decorative donut blanks the headline cards.		

On my own reports

An interaction in one of my reports that has confused a reader:

What I would set it to now (filter, highlight, or none):

Lab 2 page

Timing: Lab 2, 15 minutes in pairs, Module 3, slide 47

The steps are in the Participant Lab Guide. Write your answers and your journey here.



Figure 1. Illustration of the Referral Summary page in the starter file. Sofia Mendes needs to know whether referral growth is turning into business, and who should act.

Step 1: read the summary (3 minutes)

1. How much did referrals grow, and what happened to the win rate?

2. Which source grew the most? What is its win rate?

3. Where is the stalled pipeline? (Stalled means an open opportunity with no activity for 45 days or more.)

Step 2: map the journey (5 minutes)

Complete the template before you touch Power BI. Then wire the path with the steps in the lab guide (step 3).

Step of the journey	Our design
Level 1, summary The headline Sofia reads first, as one sentence	
Launch point The visual and the data point a user right-clicks	
Drillthrough field The field that carries the choice to the next page	
Level 2, detail What the user sees on arrival, and what tells them where they are	
Action Who does what after reading the detail page	

Step 4: walk it aloud (2 minutes)

One pair narrates its journey as Sofia would experience it. Notes for your narration:

"I open the report and read ... I notice ... I right-click ... I arrive on ... Now I know who should act: ..."

Lab 3 part B page

Timing: Lab 3 part B, 10 minutes, Module 4, slide 53
Build the visuals with the lab guide, then complete this table and discuss with your neighbor.

Every visual on the **Visual Lab** page answers the same question: **are we on our revenue target?**

Visual	What it tells me	What it makes easy	What it hides or makes hard
Card with a reference label			
Table			
Line chart			
KPI visual			
Gauge			

The card says we are ahead. The KPI says we are behind. Which one is right?

Which one would I put in front of Catherine? What would I add so that she is not misled?

Lab 3 part F page

Timing: Lab 3 part F, 5 minutes in pairs, slide 57. Then before and after, 3 minutes, slide 58

Swap screens with a partner. Run the three checks on your partner's report, then on Performance (Before).

The trust check

Check	My partner's Executive Summary	Performance (Before)
Is the message accurate?		
Is the context sufficient?		
Can the user trace from summary to supporting detail?		

The crowded page, one more time

Question	My answer
One card on Performance (Before) is wrong by a factor of about thirty. Which one, and why?	
One more card is wrong for the same reason. Which one?	
What period do the cards on that page cover?	

Before and after (slide 58)

The most important change I made was ... because ...

Activity 9: The report clinic

Timing: 35 minutes of group work, then 3 minutes per group to report. Module 5, slides 60 to 70

One sample report per group. Your instructor assigns the groups.

What we are doing

Each group takes one report and looks at it the way its business user would. You will produce an improvement backlog (keep, change, remove, add), a sketch of a better summary page with its path to detail, and a three-minute explanation of your reasoning.

The five samples are approved, redacted BMO Wealth reports. They were built by colleagues, some of whom may be in the room. We critique design choices. We do not critique people, and we do not critique the data. Redacted values stay redacted.

Critique from the business user's point of view first (slide 60)

Hold every comment against these three questions before anyone mentions colors.

1. Does the page answer a clear question?
2. Is the most important signal visually dominant?
3. Can users move from aggregate to detail without losing context?

Aesthetics and implementation come after.

Five anti-patterns to look for (slide 61)

Anti-pattern	What it looks like
Equal visual weight	Every card and chart is the same size, so nothing is the headline.
Excessive filtering controls	A wall of slicers. The reader must configure the page before it says anything.
Redundant charts	Several visuals that answer the same question in slightly different ways.
Decoration without meaning	Color, shapes, or chart types that carry no information.
Detail that competes with the summary	A long table on the summary page, pulling the eye away from the headline.

Roles and a time plan

Agree on four roles in the first minute: a **facilitator** who keeps the group on the protocol, a **scribe** who fills in the worksheet, a **timekeeper**, and a **presenter**.

Minutes	Step of the protocol (slides 62 and 70)	Worksheet
5	1 and 2. State the user, question, and decision. Find the dominant signal.	Clinic worksheet, part 1
5	3. Walk the path from summary to detail.	Clinic worksheet, part 1
5	4. Name the anti-patterns.	Clinic worksheet, part 1
8	5. Fill the keep, change, remove, add backlog.	Clinic worksheet, part 2
9	6. Sketch the improved summary page and its detail path.	Clinic worksheet, part 3
3	7. Prepare the three-minute report-out.	Clinic worksheet, part 4

The steps are the protocol on slide 62. Step 6, the sketch, comes from slide 70.

What your group delivers

- ☐ A backlog with at least one item in each quadrant: keep, change, remove, add
- ☐ A sketch of the improved summary page, with its headline sentence
- ☐ The path from that page to the supporting detail, and back
- ☐ A three-minute report-out that explains the business story, not the formatting

Our group

Our report	
Facilitator	
Scribe	
Timekeeper	
Presenter	

The five samples

Use the brief for your group's report together with whatever your instructor shows or hands out. Where a brief does not name the audience, naming it is your first job.

Sample 1: Health and Dental Insurance, Sales View (slide 65)

Purpose	Monitor sales performance and premium production by channel, product type, age band, and gender. Key metrics include gross and net policies sold, cancelled policies, customer counts, and premium amounts.
What was built	Ten KPI cards, a Sales by Channel table, six chart tiles plus a premium and policies trend, and a sidebar of ten slicers (coverage effective date, sales channel, product type, LIA, fiscal year, quarter, age band, and gender among them).
Clinic prompts	Which of the ten KPI cards should dominate? Which slicers change a decision and which can move to the Filters pane? Which breakdown charts could become small multiples or one matrix?

Sample 2: Needs Navigator, Sales Dashboard (slide 66)

Purpose	Track platform adoption, onboarding progress, user engagement, and business outcomes, from needs assessment through product fulfillment.
What was built	Seven filters (Region, Market, Transit, Employee Name, Employee Role, New 2 Bank, Date). Application Details and Internal Users tables. A product selector driving a Total Units Sold matrix. Customer Welcome Offers and Clients With CWOs tiles. Much of the canvas is empty.
Clinic prompts	What is the headline adoption signal? How would a summary-to-detail path move leadership from adoption to outcomes? Much of the canvas is empty: what earns that space?
Note	There is no screenshot of this sample in the deck. Work from the description.

Sample 3: Planning Dashboard, Wealth Plan (slide 67)

Audience	Market Leaders, Regional Leaders, Frontline Bankers.
Purpose	Help bankers find and prioritize Wealth Planning opportunities for clients above an investable-asset threshold.
Strategy	Simplicity over complexity, lead-focused, action-oriented, minimal clicks.
What was built	An RM Performance table with WP Penetration Rate % above a Client Details table.
Clinic prompts	Where does conditional formatting make penetration gaps obvious? Is the RM table a natural drillthrough source for client detail?

Sample 4: CCC Opportunity Dashboard, summary and detailed views (slide 68)

Audience	RSM, CCC Managers, frontline agents.
Purpose	Pipeline visibility and follow-up priority.
Summary view	Opportunities by CCC team and created quarter, deposit status, expected amount and YTD inflows by team, a donut and a column chart of opportunity type.
Detailed view	Four KPI cards (opportunities, same-day transactions, missing accounts, duplicates), about 20 slicers, an opportunity-level Details table with Salesforce links, and a Transaction table.
Clinic prompts	Is the donut needed when one type holds 98 percent? One slicer appears twice: which of the 20 earn their place? Should the detailed view be a drillthrough page that arrives pre-filtered?

Sample 5: Playmaker (slide 69)

Purpose	Three executive questions on one page: where are we performing, what is driving the result, and where should we act next?
What was built	ML Scorecard, Client Insights, and Private Wealth Partner KPIs, filtered by Region, Market, Team, Role, and Professional.
Path	Market to professional to household and client detail.
Clinic prompts	The deck calls this the strongest storytelling model in the set. How do page design and drillthrough make that path explicit? What should the other four reports borrow from it?

Clinic worksheet, part 1: read the report as its user

Our report: _____

Step 1. State the user, the question, and the decision

	Our answer
The user Who opens this, and how?	
The question What are they trying to find out?	
The decision What will they decide or do?	

Step 2. Find the dominant signal

What does the eye land on first?

Is it the right signal for this user? If not, what should dominate?

Step 3. Walk the path from summary to detail

How does a user get from the aggregate to the supporting detail today? Where do they lose context?

The path today, drawn as boxes and arrows



Step 4. Name the anti-patterns

Seen?	Anti-pattern	Where we saw it
	Equal visual weight	
	Excessive filtering controls	
	Redundant charts	
	Decoration without meaning	
	Detail that competes with the summary	

Clinic worksheet, part 2: the improvement backlog

Step 5. Keep, change, remove, add (slide 63). Put at least one item in **Keep**: good choices deserve protection. Write each item so that someone could act on it.

Keep	Change

Remove	Add

Clinic worksheet, part 3: the improved page

Step 6. Sketch the improved summary page and its detail path (slide 70).

The headline this page should state (one sentence, with blanks for the numbers):

The improved summary page (16:9 report canvas). Boxes and labels, not artwork.

The path to detail. What does a user select, where do they arrive, what tells them where they are, and how do they get back?

Clinic worksheet, part 4: the three-minute report-out

Step 7. Present the business-story rationale. You have three minutes. Use this outline and nothing more.

Time	Say	Our words
30 seconds	The user and the decision , in one sentence	
30 seconds	The headline the page should state	
90 seconds	One item from each quadrant: keep, change, remove, add	
30 seconds	The path to detail	

While other groups present

Listen for one idea you could use on your own report.

Group	An idea I could use

Clinic backup case: Ridgemere

Use this case if your group has no sample report to look at, or if your instructor assigns it.

Report	Wealth Production Dashboard, page Performance (Before). You know it from the opening critique.
User	Catherine Bouchard, Head of Wealth Distribution. She reads on a tablet, before the executive committee, and gives the page about five seconds.
Her request	"Revenue, balances, accounts, and new openings for FY2026 by region. One page please."
What was built	Ten slicers, eight cards of equal size, and nine tiles: a pie, a donut, a clustered column chart, a line chart, a stacked column chart, a gauge, a treemap, a funnel, and a table of advisors.
Clinic prompts	Which of the eight cards should dominate? Which slicers change a decision for Catherine? Which tiles answer a question she actually has? Where should the advisor table live?

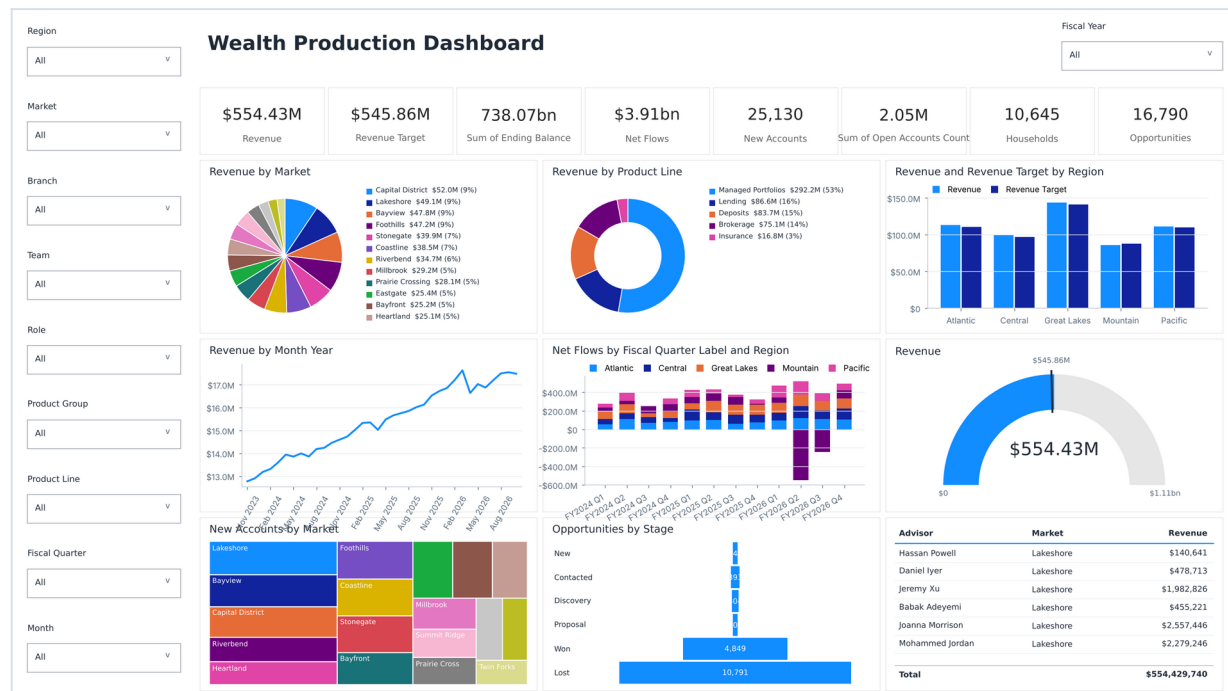


Figure 2. Illustration of the page Performance (Before)

You have an advantage that the other groups do not: you have already seen, and built, one answer. Do not copy it. Run the protocol and see whether your group lands somewhere different.

Activity 10: Paginated or interactive

Timing: 3 minutes, Wrap-up, slide 74
Mark each one on your own, then check with the room.

Slide 74 compares two kinds of report. Paginated reports are optimized for printing or PDF. Power BI reports are optimized for exploration and interactivity.

For each output, mark **P** (paginated report) or **I** (interactive Power BI report).

	The output	P or I	What tipped it
1	A monthly client statement that must print on letter paper		
2	Catherine's year-end summary, with drillthrough to the detail		
3	A 3,000-row list of households for a compliance file, every row printed		
4	A market leader exploring which advisors need help		
5	A formatted regulatory schedule exported to PDF each quarter		

My rule of thumb

I would choose a paginated report when ...

On my own reports

A table of mine that readers export, print, or scroll through, and that might be better as a paginated report:

Course review checklist

Timing: 3 minutes, Wrap-up, slide 76

Score the report you named at the start of the day. Keep this page beside every report review.

Slide 76 gives nine words. Each one becomes a test question. Score **0** if it is missing, **1** if it is partly there, and **2** if it is clear.

Report reviewed: _____ Date: _____

Check	The test question	Score	What I would change
Audience	Can I name who opens this, and how?		
Decision	Can I say what they will decide or do?		
Headline insight	Can I state the main message in one sentence, and does the page state it?		
Visual fit	Does each visual match the question it answers?		
Hierarchy	Is the most important signal the most prominent thing?		
Interaction	Does every slicer and interaction earn its place?		
Detail path	Can a user get from the summary to the supporting detail, and back?		
Trust	Is the message accurate, and is the context sufficient?		
Actionability	Is it clear what to do next?		

Total: _____ out of 18

Total	What it suggests
15 to 18	A report that tells its story. Protect what works, and ask a colleague to run the same check.
9 to 14	A sound base. Your three lowest scores are your first three backlog items.
0 to 8	Start again from the requirement-to-story map (Activity 5) before changing any visual.

My action plan

Timing: 5 minutes, Wrap-up, slide 77
On your own. One report, three changes, one reviewer.

Slide 77 asks you to refine one BMO report that you already own. A plan with a name and a date in it is far more likely to happen.

	My plan
The report I will refine	
Its primary audience A person or a role, and how they open it	
The decision it supports	
Its headline insight One sentence	

The first three backlog items

	What I will change	Keep, change, remove, or add	By when
1			
2			
3			

Who will review it with me, using the checklist, and by when?

The first thing I will do tomorrow:

Reference

Seven habits from today

1. **Start from the decision, not the visual.** Know who opens the report, how, and what they will do with it (slides 12 to 16).
2. **Write the headline before you build.** If you cannot state the insight in one sentence, the page is not ready to design (slides 10 and 20).
3. **Let the question pick the visual.** If you cannot say the question, you cannot pick the visual (slides 23 to 26).
4. **Give every number its context.** A period, a target, or a comparison. Ask what context prevents a wrong conclusion (slide 16).
5. **Make every slicer and every interaction earn its place.** If it does not change a decision, it moves to the Filters pane or goes (slides 29 and 37).
6. **Give detail its own page, and a way back.** Summary, diagnostic, detail: one question per level (slides 34 and 38).
7. **Open it as your reader will, and run the trust check, before release.** Accurate message, sufficient context, a traceable path (slides 56 and 57).

Visual chooser

The question is about	Strong default in Power BI	Keep in mind
Trend over time	Line chart	Add the target as a second line. A KPI visual reports the latest point only.
Ranking	Sorted bar chart	Sort by the value. Color the exceptions, not everything.
Variance or bridge	Waterfall chart	Shows how parts add to and subtract from a total.
Part-to-whole	Stacked bar. Donut only for a few parts	With many parts, or when exact comparison matters, use a sorted bar or a matrix.
Distribution	Column chart of bins, small multiples	Keep the bins in their natural order.
Correlation	Scatter chart	One point per item. Add a legend only if it explains the pattern.
Exact lookup	Table or matrix	Add conditional formatting so the reader knows where to look.
One headline number	Card with reference labels	Put the target or the change beside the number.
Status against a goal	KPI visual or gauge	Set the gauge's scale yourself. The default maximum is twice the value.

Three ways to add emphasis without adding a visual (slide 28)

- **Tables and matrices:** background color, font color, data bars, or icons on the values.
- **Bar, column, and line charts:** colors by gradient, by rules, or by a field value.
- **Most visuals:** a title or a subtitle that comes from an expression, so that it states the finding.

Before you publish: the reader checklist (slide 56)

Open the report as your reader will, and check it in this order.

- ☐ The report opens on the summary page, and the headline is the first thing read.
- ☐ Hidden pages are not in the page list.
- ☐ Drillthrough works from the summary, and the detail page says where the reader is.
- ☐ The Back button returns the reader to where they came from.
- ☐ The Filters pane shows the filters a reader needs to see, and no others.
- ☐ Selecting a data point does what you intended, and nothing else.
- ☐ Slicers are in the state a reader should start from.

Before you release: the trust check (slide 57)

1. **Is the message accurate?** Does the headline agree with the numbers, and do the summary and the detail agree with each other?
2. **Is the context sufficient?** Is the period stated? Does every headline number have a target or a comparison? Could any number be misread?
3. **Can the user trace from summary to supporting detail?** And can they get back?

Going further on Microsoft Learn

- [Design effective reports in Power BI \(learning path\)](#)
- [Tips for designing a great Power BI dashboard](#)
- [Use report page drillthrough](#)
- [Design Power BI reports for accessibility](#)
- [When to use paginated reports in Power BI](#)

